

Routers between Rs. 8001 - Rs. 11,000

Brand	BELKIN	Linksys	Buffalo	ASUS	Netgear	Linksys
Model No	Play Max N+N300	WRT320N	WZR-HP-G300NH	RT-N16	WNDR3700	WRT610N
Price (Rs)	8,199	8,999	9,000	9,500	9,900	10,999
Grand Totals (Out of 100)	58.56	77.01	65.79	63.97	72.73	70.63
Features (Out of 20)	13.18	13.53	12.8	13.6	13.58	15.98
Performance (Out of 80)	45.38	63.48	52.99	50.37	59.15	54.65
Features						
Protocols Supported (802.11 a / b / g / Draft n / Draft 2)	N / Y / Y / Y / N	Y / Y / Y / Y / N	N / Y / Y / Y / Y	N / Y / Y / N / N	Y / Y / Y / Y / N	Y / Y / Y / Y / N
Type Of WAN Port (Ethernet / ADSL / USB)	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet	Ethernet
No Of RJ45 (LAN) Ports	4	4	4	4	4	4
No Of USB Ports	2	0	1	2	0	1
Device Features:						
Power / Connectivity / LAN port / Activity Indicators (Y/N)	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y / Y
Security Indicator / Hardware Security button (Y / N)	N / Y	N / N	Y / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y
Factory-Defaults Reset Button (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Wall Mountable (Y/N)	N	Y	N	Y	Y	Y
External storage	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	Y
3G / CDMA / data card feature	N	N	Y	N	N	N
Security						
Encryption Types	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WPA / WPA2	WPA / WPA2	WPA / WPA2 / WEP
Firewall (Types Supported)	SPI / NAT	SPI / NAT	NA	NAT / SPI	SPI	SPI
LAN I/P Based Site Blocking (Y/N)	N	Y	N	N	N	Y
Wireless Isolation (Y/N)	N	Y	N	N	N	Y
Port Mapping (Forwarding)	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Firmware Interface Features:						
Basic Setup Wizard (CD / Browser) (Y / N)	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	
Online / Offline Firmware Upgrade (Y/N)	N / Y	Y / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y	N / Y
Settings, Backup To HDD / Load From HDD (Y / N)	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y	Y / Y
Ease of Installation/Use (So 10)						
Bundle (Includes Software, except firmware)	6	6.5	6.5	6	6	6
Firmware Interface	6.5	6.5	6	6	6.5	6.5
Device Configurable Settings	5	6.5	6	6	6.5	6
Build Quality	5	6	6	6	6.5	7
Performance						
Zone 1 (100 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 1 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	68	60	66	66	66	60
Sequential (MBps)	4.89	7.49	8.12	5.48	9.24	7.55
Assorted files (MBps)	2.87	3.51	2.76	2.54	3.89	3.71
Zone 2 (50 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 2 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	53	51	52	58	42	40
Sequential (MBps)	4.56	7.49	5.56	7.49	7.60	4
Assorted files (MBps)	3.20	3.59	3.08	4.18	4.68	3.13
Zone 3 (50 MB File transfer)						
Signal Strength in Zone 3 (Wireless Mon 3.0, %)	16	16	15	26	12	16
Sequential (MBps)	0.41	3.11	0.76	0.38	1.72	1.39
Assorted files (MBps)	0.30	2.22	0.90	0.32	0.88	1.25
Passmark Performance (Mbps)						
Zone 1	4.53	6.62	6.36	5.77	7.94	6.52
Zone 2	4.51	6.36	7.00	6.21	8.32	4.79
Zone 3	0.74	2.88	0.76	0	6.53	1.08
Video Streaming (So 10)						
HD 1080p - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 5	8 / 8 / 8	8 / 8 / 8	8 / 8 / 4	8 / 8 / 3	8 / 8 / 8
DVD - Zone 1 / 2 / 3	8 / 8 / 2	8 / 8 / 6	8 / 8 / 4	8 / 8 / 3	8 / 8 / 3	8 / 8 / 8

Above Rs. 11,001

In this price range, we're getting into the niche products. Security is key and support for other internet connectivity methods such as 3G come into the picture. Some of the products were received were also lifestyle products.

Features

The Apple Time Capsule is a backup server cum dual-band 802.11n wireless router with

a 1TB drive built into it. It also works as a print server. Apple makes some of the well designed quality products and it's obvious with the Time Capsule as well as the Airport Extreme. Both have external external storage support through USB. The products aren't designed to be economical. The Time Capsule tops the price charts in this test at a whopping Rs.27,500. The Airport Extreme isn't exactly cheap either, at Rs. 11,450. These two products are

configured using the AirPort utility. We had some trouble initially configuring the product with our network configuration. Eventually, we were able to manually access the router and get it running. In comparison to the Apple products, the D-Link DIR-455 is a very simple product. Voice calling functionality and ability to use 3G SIM cards are some of its key features.

The Zyxel NBG-460N is an 802.11n router with a firmware

which is reasonably simple to use even for home users. Its price is Rs. 13,000 which on the other hand isn't very home-user friendly. Security features are straight-forward and users can configure things very easily. Build is average. The scheduling feature to turn off the wireless connection is useful. Build quality could have been better and the device heats up quite a bit. With a price tag of Rs.13,000, users expect more features like dual band, printer